

Printer languages

Adobe's Postscript and HP's Printer Command Language which depict a page to be printed in vector form



INKJET PRINTERS FOR HOMES

BRAND	Canon	Canon
Model	PIXMA iP1980	PIXMA iP3680
Price	Rs. 2,695	Rs. 5,595
Grand total (out of 100)	50.60	53.55
Features (out of 40)	11.12	13.84
Performance (out of 60)	39.48	39.71
FEATURES		
Maximum print resolution (dpi)	4800 x 1200	9600 x 2400
Power saving mode (Y/N)	N	N
Duplex printing (Y/N)	N	N
Ink saving mode (Y/N)	N	N
Zoom / fit to page (Y/N)	N	N
Colour correction on printer (Y/N)	N	N
Size of display on printer	NA	NA
Number of cartridges used	2	5
Cartridge colours	Black and Colour	CMYK and Black
CONNECTIVITY		
PictBridge support (Y/N)	N	Y
USB flash drive support (Y/N)	N	N
Network printing support (Y/N)	N	N
Wi-Fi support (Y/N)	N	N
Bluetooth printing (Y/N)	N	N
Memory card support (Y/N)	N	N
Miscellaneous		
Bundled cables	Power cable, USB cable	Power cable, USB cable
Software supplied	Easy PhotoPrint EX, My Printer	Easy PhotoPrint EX, My Printer
Dimensions (W x D x H) (mm)	442 x 237 x 152	431 x 296 x 153
Weight (kg)	3.3	5.6
PERFORMANCE		
Text print (eco)	4.50	4.50
Text print (time in seconds)	10.00	9.00
Text print (quality)	6.00	6.25
Text print (time in seconds)	10.40	10.00
Mixed document print (quality)	6.13	6.38
Mixed document print (quality) (time in seconds)	34.80	26.00
Mixed document print (speed/eco)	5.25	5.25
Mixed document print (speed/eco) (time in seconds)	20.50	21.00
Mixed document print (speed/eco) 15 copies (time)	268.00	290.00
Photo (eco)	7.25	7.13
Photo (eco) (time in seconds)	94.00	122.00
Photo (quality)	7.38	7.38
Photo (quality) (Time in seconds)	181.00	168.00
Build quality (out of 10)		
Body	5	7
Folding / hinges	4.5	6
Tray quality	5.5	6
Buttons	6	7
Ease of use (out of 10)		
Hardware connections	7	7
Cartridge installation	7	5
Paper loading	7	6
Software user interface	6	6
Ink levels	7	7

Canon Laser Shot LBP3300

This printer has a plastic matte finish body, with good build quality. It has four indicators on top, and no moving flaps, which gives it a sturdier build.

A quick driver installation, and the printer is ready for installation, which is painless – detach the front, put in the cartridge and you're good to go. It also takes this printer very little time to warm up.

The input paper tray has a capacity of 250 sheets and is at the base of the printer. An interesting feature here is a notch that indicates the level of paper in the input tray. There's no output tray, and a small secondary tray is located above the main base tray, but it's flimsy.

This printer supports duplex printing, and output is quick. It doesn't take long to warm up, and is ideal for home and office use. It's also great for printing books, because it's one of the faster printers around.

Brother HL 2140

Brother's a brand known for its multifunctional devices. The HL2140 was one of the four printers they sent across. An entry level monochrome laser printer, the HL 2140 is very plain looking printer. The all-plastic body is strong and it has rounded edges on all sides. There is one input tray located at the base, and a face down output tray with a small manual feed paper guide. There are status lights for Toner, Drum and Error and a power button on the side.

We encountered problems like paper jamming when we used glossy paper for a photo printout. The printer tends to take in two papers simultaneously, thus getting jammed in the process. For this printer, the photograph test was carried out on normal paper. The printer is fast, taking as little as 11 seconds for a normal text printout.

Brother HL 2150N

On first glance, the HL2150N looks exactly like HL2140, but on close observation one notices a major addition. While the HL 2140 has no network connectivity, the HL 2150N does.

The body structure is very similar to the HL 2140. The tray is quite strong even though its not as smooth as we would like.

Like the HL 2140, this printer also performs poorly with glossy paper. Not that it's meant to print photographs, but paper jams are inexcusable.

However, printing on plain paper is a smooth process. This is ideal for home networks or for use in small office setups with bulk document printing.